

Near-side azimuthal and pseudo-rapidity correlations of neutral strange baryons and mesons in d +Au, Cu+Cu and Au+Au collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200$ GeV

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We present results on the near-side of high- p_T triggered di-hadron correlations of neutral strange baryons (Λ , $\bar{\Lambda}$) and mesons (K_S^0) at intermediate $p_T = 2$ -6 GeV/ c in d +Au, Cu+Cu and Au+Au collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200$ GeV measured by the STAR experiment at RHIC. The near-side di-hadron correlation in $(\Delta\phi, \Delta\eta)$ contains two structures, a peak which is narrow in $\Delta\phi$ and $\Delta\eta$ consistent with correlations due to jet fragmentation and correlation in $\Delta\phi$ which is broad in $\Delta\eta$ which is attributed dominantly to flow. The dependence of the conditional yield of the jet-like correlation on the trigger particle momentum, associated particle momentum, and centrality are presented. In addition the particle composition of the jet-like correlation is determined using identified associated particles. Data on identified triggers are qualitatively described by PYTHIA, however the composition of the jet-like correlation is not quantitatively described by PYTHIA.

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I. INTRODUCTION

Ultra-relativistic heavy-ion collisions create a unique environment for the investigation of nuclear matter at extreme temperatures and energy densities in the laboratory. Measurements of nuclear modification factors [1–4] have shown that the nuclear medium created is opaque to particles with large transverse momentum (p_T). Moreover, anisotropic elliptic flow measurements demonstrate that the medium exhibits partonic degrees of freedom and has properties close to those expected of a perfect fluid [5, 6].

Studies of jets in heavy ion collisions are possible through single particle measurements [1–4], di-hadron correlations [7–17], and measurements of reconstructed jets [3, 18–21]. Measurements of reconstructed jets are useful for studying higher momenta and have provided direct evidence for partonic energy loss in the medium. However, di-hadron correlations provide complementary measurements since they enable studies of intermediate momenta, studies where the jet may be so severely modified that it is no longer recognizable as a jet, and studies where the interplay between jets and the medium is important.

Properties of jets have been studied extensively using di-hadron correlations relative to a trigger particle with large transverse momentum at the Relativistic Heavy Ion Collider (RHIC) [7–14] and the Large Hadron Collider (LHC) [15–17]. Systematic studies of associated particle distributions on the opposite side of the trigger particle revealed significant modification [5, 10, 11]. The associated particle distribution on the near side of the trigger particle, the subject of this paper, is also significantly modified in central Au+Au collisions [5, 7, 8]. In p + p and d +Au collisions, there is a peak narrow in azimuth ($\Delta\phi$) and pseudorapidity ($\Delta\eta$) around the trigger particle, which we refer to as the jet-like correlation. In Cu+Cu and Au+Au collisions this peak is observed to be broader than that in d +Au collisions, although the yields

are comparable [14]. This indicates that the jet-like correlation is dominantly produced through fragmentation.

Besides the shape modifications of jet-like correlations at intermediate transverse momentum range, the production mechanism of hadrons seems to differ from simple fragmentation. Baryon production is less suppressed in central Au+Au collisions than that of mesons resulting in baryon to meson ratios enhanced in central Au+Au collisions relative to p + p and d +Au collisions [22, 23]. The measured baryon to meson ratios increase with p_T until reaching their maximum value of ≈ 3 relative to p + p collisions at $p_T \approx 3$ GeV/ c in both the strange and non-strange quark sectors. A fall-off of the baryon to meson ratio is observed for $p_T > 3$ GeV/ c and both the strange and non-strange baryon to meson ratios in Au+Au collisions approach the values measured in p + p collisions at $p_T \approx 6$ GeV/ c .

In this paper, studies of two-particle correlations on the near-side in d +Au, Cu+Cu and Au+Au collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200$ GeV measured by the STAR experiment are presented. Results from two-particle correlations in pseudo-rapidity and azimuth for neutral strange baryons (Λ , $\bar{\Lambda}$) and mesons (K_S^0) at intermediate p_T ($2 < p_T < 6$ GeV/ c) in the different collision systems are compared to unidentified charged hadron correlations. Both identified trigger particles associated with charged particles (K_S^0 -h, Λ -h) and unidentified charged trigger particles associated with identified strange particles (h- K_S^0 , h- Λ) are studied. The near-side jet-like yield is studied as a function of centrality of the collision and transverse momentum of trigger and associated particles to look for possible flavor and baryon/meson. The composition of the jet-like correlation is studied using identified associated particles to investigate possible production mechanisms. Results are compared to expectations from PYTHIA.

II. EXPERIMENTAL SETUP AND PARTICLE RECONSTRUCTION

The results presented in this paper are based on analysis of data from d +Au, Cu+Cu, and Au+Au collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200$ GeV taken by the STAR experiment in 2003, 2005, and 2004, respectively. For d +Au collisions, the events analyzed were selected using a minimally biased (MB) trigger requiring at least one beam-rapidity neutron in the Zero Degree Calorimeter (ZDC), located 18 m from the nominal interaction point in the Au beam direction and accepting $95 \pm 3\%$ of the hadronic cross section [24]. For Cu+Cu collisions, the MB trigger was based on the combined signals from the Beam-Beam Counters (BBC) placed at forward pseudo-rapidity ($3.3 < |\eta| < 5.0$) and a coincidence between the two ZDCs. The MB Au+Au events were obtained using a ZDC coincidence, a signal in both BBCs and a minimum charged particle multiplicity in an array of scintillator slats arranged in a barrel, the Central Trigger Barrel (CTB), to reject non-hadronic interactions. An additional online trigger for central Au+Au collisions was used. This trigger was based on the energy deposited in the ZDCs in combination with the multiplicity in the CTB. The central trigger sampled the most central 12% of the total hadronic cross section.

In order to achieve a more uniform detector acceptance in Cu+Cu and Au+Au data sets, only those events with the primary vertex position along the longitudinal beam direction (z) within 30 cm of the center of the STAR detector were used for the analysis. For the d +Au collisions this vertex position selection was extended to $|z| < 50$ cm. The number of events after the vertex cuts in individual data samples is summarized in table II.

STAR [25] is a multi-purpose spectrometer with a full azimuthal coverage consisting of several detectors inside a large solenoidal magnet with a uniform magnetic field of 0.5 T applied along the beam line. This analysis is based exclusively on charged particle tracks detected and reconstructed in the Time Projection Chamber (TPC) [26], with a pseudo-rapidity acceptance $|\eta| < 1.5$. The TPC has in total 45 pad rows in the radial direction allowing up to 45 independent spatial and energy loss (dE/dx) measurements for each charged particle track. The TPC momentum resolution is determined to be $\Delta p/p \sim 0.0078 + 0.0098 \cdot p_T$ (GeV/c) [26]. Charged particle tracks used in this analysis were required to have at least 15 fit points in the TPC, a DCA to the primary vertex of less than 1 cm and a pseudorapidity $|\eta| < 1.0$.

We identify weakly decaying neutral strange (V^0) particles Λ , $\bar{\Lambda}$ and K_S^0 by topological reconstruction of their decay vertices from their charged hadron daughters measured in the TPC as described in [27]:

$$\begin{aligned}\Lambda &\rightarrow p + \pi^-, BR = (63.9 \pm 0.5)\% \\ \bar{\Lambda} &\rightarrow \bar{p} + \pi^+, BR = (63.9 \pm 0.5)\% \\ K_S^0 &\rightarrow \pi^+ + \pi^-, BR = (68.95 \pm 0.14)\%\end{aligned}\quad (1)$$

where BR denotes the branching ratio. The STAR V^0 finding reconstruction software pairs oppositely charged particle tracks into V^0 candidates. Reconstructed Λ and K_S^0 particles are required to be within $|\eta| < 1.0$. Topological cuts are optimized for each data set and yield signal to background ratio of at $\geq 15:1$. For the analyses presented here, no significant difference was observed between results with Λ and $\bar{\Lambda}$ trigger and associated particles so the correlations were added to increase statistics. In the remainder of the discussion the combined particles are referred to simply as Λ baryons.

III. METHOD

A. Correlation technique

The analysis in this paper follows the method in [14]. A high- p_T trigger particle was selected and the raw distribution of associated tracks relative to that trigger in pseudorapidity ($\Delta\eta$) and azimuth ($\Delta\phi$) is formed. This distribution, $d^2 N_{\text{raw}}/d\Delta\phi d\Delta\eta$, is normalized by the number of trigger particles, N_{trigger} , and corrected for the efficiency and acceptance of associated tracks ε :

$$\frac{d^2 N}{d\Delta\phi d\Delta\eta}(\Delta\phi, \Delta\eta) = \frac{1}{N_{\text{trigger}}} \frac{d^2 N_{\text{raw}}}{d\Delta\phi d\Delta\eta} \frac{1}{\varepsilon_{\text{assoc}}(\phi, \eta)} \frac{1}{\varepsilon_{\text{pair}}(\Delta\phi, \Delta\eta)}. \quad (2)$$

The efficiency correction $\varepsilon_{\text{assoc}}(\phi, \eta)$ is a correction for the single particle reconstruction efficiency in TPC and $\varepsilon_{\text{pair}}(\Delta\phi, \Delta\eta)$ is a correction for the finite TPC track-pair acceptance in $\Delta\phi$ and $\Delta\eta$. Since the correlations are normalized per trigger, the efficiency correction is only applied for the associated particle. The fully corrected correlation functions are averaged between positive and negative $\Delta\phi$ and $\Delta\eta$ regions and are reflected about $\Delta\phi = 0$ and $\Delta\eta = 0$ in the plots.

B. Single charged track efficiency correction

For unidentified associated particles, the efficiency correction $\varepsilon_{\text{assoc}}(\phi, \eta)$ is the correction for charged hadrons, identical to that applied in [14]. This single charged track reconstruction efficiency is determined as a function of p_T , η , and centrality by simulating the TPC response to a particle and embedding the simulated signals into a

TABLE I: Number of events after cuts (see text) in the data samples analyzed.

System	Centrality	No. of events [10^6]
d +Au	0-95%	3
Cu+Cu	0-60%	38
Au+Au	0-80%	28
Au+Au	0-12%	17

real event. The single charged track efficiency is found to be approximately constant for $p_T > 2$ GeV/c and ranges from around 75% for central Au+Au events to around 85% for peripheral Cu+Cu events. The efficiency for reconstructing a track in d +Au events is 89%.

For identified strange associated particles, the reconstruction efficiency $\varepsilon_{\text{assoc}}(\phi, \eta)$ is determined in a similar way, but forcing the simulated particle to decay through the channel in equation 2 and then correcting for the respective branching ratio. The efficiency for Λ , $\bar{\Lambda}$, and K_S^0 ranges from 8% to 15%, increasing with momentum and decreasing with system size.

The systematic uncertainty on the efficiency correction for unidentified associated hadrons, 5%, is strongly correlated across centralities and p_T bins for each data set but not between data sets. For identified associated particle ratios the systematic errors on the efficiency correction partially cancel out and are negligible compared to the statistical uncertainties.

For the inclusive spectra the feeddown correction due to secondary Λ from Ξ baryon decays is 15%, independent of p_T [28]. For identified Λ trigger particles, we assume that feeddown lambdas do not change the correlation since little trigger particle type dependence is observed in the data. For identified associated particles, we assume the same correlation between primary and secondary Λ baryons and correct the yield of Λ associated particles by reducing the yield by 15%.

C. Pair acceptance correction

The requirement of each track being measured within $|\eta| < 1.0$ in TPC, results in a limited acceptance for track pairs. In pseudorapidity the track pair geometric acceptance is $\approx 100\%$ for $\Delta\eta \approx 0$, however, near $\Delta\eta \approx 2$ the acceptance is close to 0%. In azimuth the acceptance is limited by the 12 TPC sector boundaries, leading to dips in the acceptance of track pairs in $\Delta\phi$. To correct for the limited geometric acceptance, a mixed event analysis was performed using trigger particles from one event combined with associated particles from another event, as done in [7]. The position of the event vertices were required to be within 2 cm of each other along the beam axis and have the same charged particle multiplicity within 10 particles. To increase statistics of the mixed event sample, each event with a trigger particle was mixed with ten other events.

D. Track merging correction

The track merging effect in unidentified hadron (h) correlations discussed in [14] is also present for V^0 -h and h- V^0 correlations. This effect leads to a dip at small $\Delta\phi$ and $\Delta\eta$ due to overlap between the trigger and associated particles. When one of the particles is a V^0 , this overlap is between one of the V^0 daughter particles and

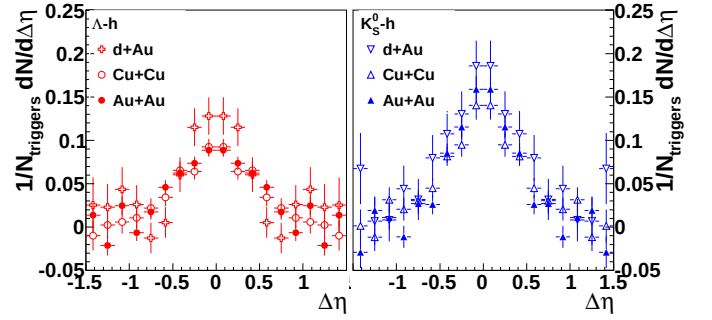


FIG. 1: Corrected correlation functions $\frac{dN_I}{d\Delta\eta}$ in $|\Delta\phi| = 1.0$ for $3 < p_T^{\text{trigger}} < 6$ GeV/c and 1.5 GeV/c $< p_T^{\text{associated}} < p_T^{\text{trigger}}$ for Λ -h (left) and K_S^0 -h (right) for minimum bias d +Au, 0-20% Cu+Cu, and 40-80% Au+Au collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200$ GeV. The data have been reflected about $\Delta\eta = 0$.

the unidentified hadron. The size of the dip due to track merging depends strongly on the relative momenta of the particle pair. This effect is larger when the overlapping particles' momenta are closer. For V^0 -h correlations, the typical associated particle momentum is approximately 1.5 GeV/c. Since the K_S^0 decay is symmetric, this means that the track merging effect is greatest for K_S^0 -h correlations with a trigger K_S^0 momentum of approximately 3 GeV/c. In a Λ decay, the proton daughter carries more of the Λ momentum than the pion daughter. Therefore this effect is larger for Λ trigger particles with lower momenta. Since track merging affects both signal and background particles and the signal sits on top of a large combinatorial background, the effect is larger for collisions with a higher charged track multiplicity. Since the dip in V^0 -h and h- V^0 correlations is the result of a V^0 daughter merged with an unidentified hadron, the dip is wider in $\Delta\phi$ and $\Delta\eta$ than in unidentified hadron correlations. When the track merging dip is present, it is corrected by fitting a Gaussian to the peak, excluding the region impacted by track merging, and using the fit to extract the yield.

E. Yield extraction

Extraction of the yield in this paper follows the method and the notation in [7, 14]. The jet-like correlation is narrow in both $\Delta\phi$ and $\Delta\eta$ and is contained within the kinematic cuts in p_T^{trigger} and $p_T^{\text{associated}}$ used in this analysis. The di-hadron correlation from equation 2 is projected onto the $\Delta\eta$ axis:

$$\left. \frac{dN}{d\Delta\eta} \right|_{a,b} \equiv \int_a^b d\Delta\phi \frac{d^2N}{d\Delta\phi d\Delta\eta}. \quad (3)$$

All other correlations, including those from v_2 , $V_{3\Delta}$, and higher order flow harmonics, are assumed to be independent of $\Delta\eta$ within the η acceptance of the analysis,

consistent with [7, 29–31]. This means that the jet-like yield can be determined by:

$$\frac{dN_J}{d\Delta\eta}(\Delta\eta) = \left. \frac{dN}{d\Delta\eta} \right|_{-0.78, 0.78} - b_{\Delta\eta} \quad (4)$$

where $b_{\Delta\eta}$ is a constant offset determined by fitting a constant background $b_{\Delta\eta}$ plus a Gaussian to $\frac{dN_J}{d\Delta\eta}(\Delta\eta)$. Sample correlations are given in Figure 1. When the dip due to track merging is negligible, the yield determined from fit is discarded to avoid any assumptions about the shape of the peak and instead we integrate equation 4 over $\Delta\eta$ using bin counting to determine the jet-like yield $Y_J^{\Delta\eta}$:

$$Y_J^{\Delta\eta} = \int_{-0.78}^{0.78} d\Delta\eta \frac{dN_J}{d\Delta\eta}(\Delta\eta) . \quad (5)$$

When it is not possible, the yield from the Gaussian fit is used, excluding the region affected by track merging and the statistical errors from the fit exceed any error from the assumption of a Gaussian shape.

IV. RESULTS

A. Charged- V^0 correlations

Previous studies demonstrated that the jet-like correlation in h-h correlations is consistent across collision systems [7, 14, 32] and that it is qualitatively described by PYTHIA [14]. This indicates that the jet-like correlation is dominantly produced by fragmentation, even at intermediate momenta ($2 < p_T < 6$) where recombination is expected to contribute substantially to the bulk production of particles. The composition of the jet-like correlation can be studied using correlations with identified associated particles. The statistics of the $d+Au$ data were limited and the Au+Au data set was limited by the presence of residual track merging. Therefore it was only possible to determine the composition of the jet-like correlation in Cu+Cu collisions.

These data are shown in figure 2 and compared to data from inclusive spectra in $p+p$ collisions from STAR [33] and ALICE [34] and from PYTHIA [35] calculations from the Perugia 2010 and 2011 [36] tunes. The Cu+Cu data are consistent with the inclusive particle ratios from $p+p$. This further supports earlier observations that the jet-like correlation is dominantly produced by fragmentation since the production of particles both in $p+p$ collisions at these momenta and in the jet-like correlation are expected to be dominated by fragmentation. This indicates that production of strange particles through recombination is not significant in the jet-like correlation, even in A+A collisions. The $\frac{\Lambda+\bar{\Lambda}}{2K_S^0}$ ratio is also consistent between inclusive measurements at different energies.

However, the production of strangeness and of baryons is potentially more complicated. PYTHIA is able to de-

scribe pion and omega production [37, 38], however, generally underestimates production of strange particles and baryons [33, 34, 37, 38]. In figure 2 PYTHIA underestimates the $\frac{\Lambda+\bar{\Lambda}}{2K_S^0}$ ratio, both in Tune A and the Perugia tunes, which improved the description of inclusive strangeness production at LHC energies. PYTHIA also underestimates the $\frac{\Lambda+\bar{\Lambda}}{2K_S^0}$ ratio at higher energies and predicts a change in the $\frac{\Lambda+\bar{\Lambda}}{2K_S^0}$ ratio with energy. For each of the PYTHIA tunes used, the inclusive ratio and the ratio in the jet-like correlation are comparable and lower than that observed in the data. This indicates that even though PYTHIA underestimates the overall production of both the Λ baryon and the K_S^0 meson, it also predicts that both the inclusive production and the production in jet-like correlation are dominated by fragmentation.

h- K_S^0 and h- Λ correlations are likely dominated by gluon and light quark jets, indicating that PYTHIA is underestimating the production of strange particles in light jets. However, K_S^0 -h and Λ -h correlations should have larger contributions from strange jets. It may be easier for a PYTHIA to describe the fragmentation of a jet containing a strange particle than to describe the production of strange particles from non-strange jets.

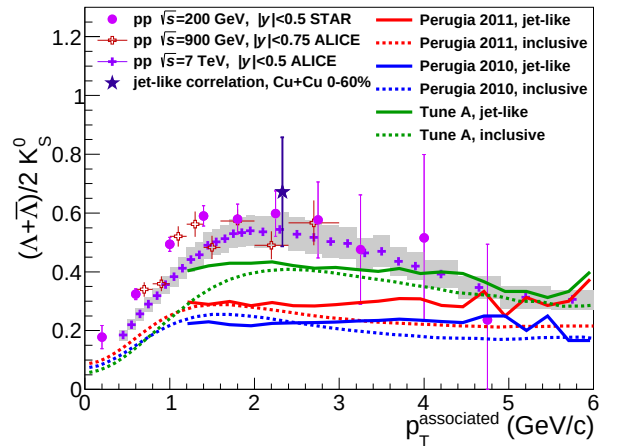


FIG. 2: Λ/K_S^0 ratio measured in the jet-like correlation in 0-60% Cu+Cu collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200$ GeV for $3 < p_T^{\text{trigger}} < 6$ GeV/c and $2.0 < p_T^{\text{associated}} < 3.0$ GeV/c along with this ratio obtained from inclusive p_T spectra in $p+p$ collisions.

B. Correlations with identified strange trigger particles

We investigate dihadron correlations with an identified strange trigger in order to determine if we can disentangle effects due to strangeness production and effects due to difficulties describing strangeness in PYTHIA. The jet-like yield as a function of p_T^{trigger} is shown in figure 3 for h-h [14], K_S^0 -h, and Λ -h correlations for $d+Au$, Cu+Cu,

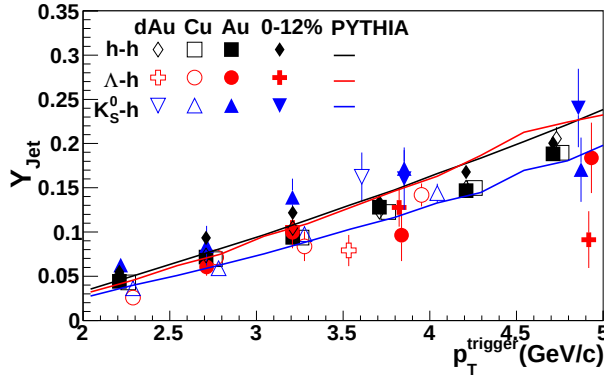


FIG. 3: The jet-like yield in $|\Delta\eta| < 0.78$ as a function of p_T^{trigger} for h-h [14], K_S^0 -h, and Λ -h correlations for $1.5 \text{ GeV}/c < p_T^{\text{associated}} < p_T^{\text{trigger}}$ in minimum bias d+Au, 0-60% Cu+Cu, and Au+Au collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200 \text{ GeV}$. The data from Au+Au collisions are shown in two centrality bins, 40-80% and 0-12%. The data are compared to PYTHIA [35] calculations using the Perugia 2011 tune [36].

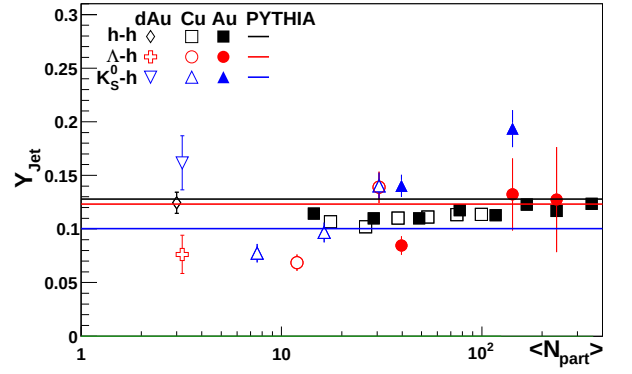


FIG. 4: Centrality dependence of the jet-like yield of h-h, K_S^0 -h, and Λ -h correlations for $3 < p_T^{\text{trigger}} < 6 \text{ GeV}/c$ and $1.5 \text{ GeV}/c < p_T^{\text{associated}} < p_T^{\text{trigger}}$ in d+Au, Cu+Cu, and Au+Au collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200 \text{ GeV}$. The data are compared to PYTHIA [35] calculations using the Perugia 2011 tune [36]. Points have been shifted for visibility.

and Au+Au collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200 \text{ GeV}$. Due to residual track merging effects, fits are used for Λ -h correlations in Cu+Cu collisions with $2.0 < p_T^{\text{trigger}} < 3.0 \text{ GeV}/c$, in 0-12% Au+Au collisions for $3.0 < p_T^{\text{trigger}} < 4.5 \text{ GeV}/c$, and in 40-80% Au+Au collisions for $2.0 < p_T^{\text{trigger}} < 4.5 \text{ GeV}/c$ and for K_S^0 -h correlations in 0-12% Au+Au collisions for $3.0 < p_T^{\text{trigger}} < 3.5 \text{ GeV}/c$ and 40-80% Au+Au collisions for $2.0 < p_T^{\text{trigger}} < 4.5 \text{ GeV}/c$. There is no significant difference in the yields between the collision systems as observed earlier for h-h correlations in [14]. This includes no significant difference between results from Au+Au collisions in 40-80% and 0-12% central collisions, although there is a hint that the Λ -h jet-like yield may be lower in central Au+Au collisions, particularly at high p_T . The jet-like yield from K_S^0 -h correlations is systematically above the jet-like yield from h-h correlations and the jet-like yield from Λ -h is systematically below the jet-like yield from h-h correlations, particularly in Au+Au collisions. Data are compared to PYTHIA calculations from the Perugia 2011 [36] tune. PYTHIA describes the trend of the jet-like yield well for all particle species. However, the trigger particle type ordering in PYTHIA is opposite that observed in the data, with the Λ -h jet-like yield comparable to the h-h jet-like yield, which is higher than K_S^0 -h jet-like yield.

Next the jet-like yields are studied as a function of collision centrality expressed in terms of number of participating nucleons (N_{part}) calculated from the Glauber model [39]. The extracted jet-like yield as a function of N_{part} is shown in figure 4 for h-h [14], K_S^0 -h, and Λ -h correlations for d+Au, Cu+Cu, and Au+Au collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200 \text{ GeV}$. All yields are determined using bin counting. While there is no centrality dependence in the jet-like yield of h-h correlations, there is a centrality dependence in the yields of the K_S^0 -h and Λ -h correlations. These data are compared to PYTHIA [35] calculations

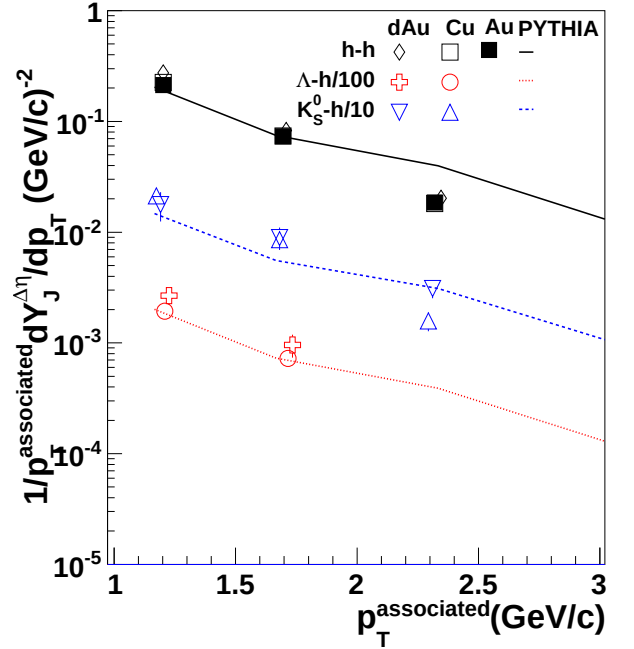


FIG. 5: The jet-like yield as a function of $p_T^{\text{associated}}$ for h-h [14], K_S^0 -h, and Λ -h correlations for $3 < p_T^{\text{trigger}} < 6 \text{ GeV}/c$ in d+Au, 0-60% Cu+Cu, and Au+Au collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200 \text{ GeV}$. The data from Au+Au collisions are shown in two centrality bins, 40-80% and 0-12%. The data are compared to PYTHIA [35] calculations using the Perugia 2011 tune [36].

from the Perugia 2011 [36] tune.

The jet-like yield as a function of $p_T^{\text{associated}}$ is shown in figure 5 for h-h [14], K_S^0 -h, and Λ -h correlations for d+Au and Cu+Cu collisions at $\sqrt{s_{NN}} = 200 \text{ GeV}$. All yields are determined using bin counting. The Λ -h and K_S^0 -h correlations are only shown for d+Au and Cu+Cu collisions since residual track merging made measurements

in Au+Au collisions difficult. These data are compared to PYTHIA [35] calculations from the Perugia 2011 [36] tune.

1. Particle type dependence

The particle type dependence is of interest because effects such as recombination are expected to be significant in this momentum range for the inclusive spectra, however, the contribution to the jet-like correlation from recombination is expected to be small from the results in section IV A. The jet-like yield shows a systematic particle type dependence, with the jet-like yield highest for K_S^0 -h correlations and lowest for Λ -h correlations. The fact that this is also observed in d +Au indicates that this particle type dependence is not due to medium modification.

The discrepancy in the particle type ordering between PYTHIA and the data could be from different jet-like correlation widths, differences in the fraction of energy taken by the leading parton, or differences in the shapes of the jet spectra leading to the correlations. The jet-like yield in this paper is defined within a fixed $\Delta\eta$ and $\Delta\phi$ region. The particle type order could be explained if the widths of the jet-like correlation were greatest for K_S^0 -h correlations and narrowest for Λ -h correlations.

The difference in the ordering could also come from an over or underestimate of the fraction of momentum taken by a leading K_S^0 or Λ . If the leading parton takes more energy, there is less energy left over for particle production. This means that if PYTHIA underestimates (overestimates) the fraction of momentum taken by a leading Λ (K_S^0), it will overestimate (underestimate) the yield. Similarly, a difference in the jet spectra could lead to a difference in the observed particle ordering. Higher energy jets produce more particles, so if the spectrum of jets leading to the K_S^0 -h (Λ -h) correlation is harder (softer) in PYTHIA than in the data, this could explain the discrepancy in the ordering.

The precision of this data set does not allow for studies of the widths of the jet-like yield, however, this would be an area of interest for future studies, particularly in smaller collision systems such as p + p and d +Au. Further information on the fragmentation functions of strange particles in light jets and jets with leading strange particles would also help refine the PYTHIA predictions for the production of strange particles in jets. This could potentially lead to insight into the discrepancies between the data and PYTHIA predictions for the production of baryons and strange particles.

2. Centrality dependence

The jet-like yield in h-h collisions as a function of p_T^{trigger} , N_{part} , and $p_T^{\text{associated}}$ is independent of collision

system [14], however, the jet-like yield is not independent of collision system in Λ -h and K_S^0 -h correlations. Figure 3 shows hints that the Λ -h yield is lower in 0-12% central Au+Au collisions, particularly at high p_T , than in other collision systems. However, figure 4 shows that the jet-like yield is slightly higher in central 0-12% central Au+Au collisions. Figure 4 and figure 5 also indicate that the jet-like yield changes with collision system. Given the different range of momenta studied, this indicates a momentum dependence, however, the precision of these data does not allow the details of this momentum dependence to be disentangled.

There are several effects which may explain the observed system dependence of the jet-like yield. The basic mechanisms involve either modification of the jet-like correlation itself or differences in the jet spectra which leads to the jet-like correlations. The fragmentation function of the jets could be modified. It is possible that the fragmentation function could be modified for strange particles but not for light quarks. The width of the jet-like correlation could increase, for instance if jets which produce strange particles were more likely to emit bremsstrahlung gluons. Differences in the jet spectra sampled by different trigger particles could also lead to differences in the observed jet-like yield. A higher energy jet produces more particles, so suppression of lower energy jets would lead to an increase in the observed jet-like yield. If identified trigger particles were more likely to come from quark or antiquark jets but unidentified trigger particles were dominated by gluon jets, a difference between quark and gluon jet spectra could lead to differences in the jet-like yield. These data indicate that one or many of these effects are present for correlations with identified strange triggers, however, these data do not have the precision to disentangle these effects.

V. CONCLUSIONS

We observe a trend for mass ordering of the yield of identified strange trigger particles in d +Au, Cu+Cu, and Au+Au collisions. This mass ordering is not the same ordering observed for the jet-like yield in PYTHIA. The $\frac{\Lambda+\bar{\Lambda}}{2K_S^0}$ ratio for the jet-like correlation is comparable to that observed in p + p collisions, providing further evidence that this correlation is dominantly produced by fragmentation. In PYTHIA, this ratio is comparable to the inclusive ratio. PYTHIA is unable to describe either the inclusive ratios or the ratio in the jet-like correlation. This indicates that there may still be some problems with the production mechanism for strange particles in PYTHIA.

These studies provide motivation for future studies of strangeness production in jets. Larger data sets and data from collisions at higher energies could provide more robust tests of the strangeness production mechanism in p + p collisions. Studies in p + p would be essential in order to search for modifications of strangeness production

in jets in heavy ion collisions.

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